acknowledgments

Writing a book is a long-term commitment, usually a year or longer. While this is not my first book, and I was able to apply lessons learned from the past experiences, it goes without saying that the outcome is something I didn't achieve on my own, as a number of people helped shape and improve this book.

To start, I'd like to thank my family, who supported and motivated me the entire time! Next, I'd like to say a big thank you to Ian Hough, my editor at Manning, for all your guidance (and patience). While I spent most of the time with Ian, there are several folks at Manning who helped make this book a reality, and I am grateful for everything you did: Malena Selic, Marina Matesic, Ivan Martinović, Rebecca Rinehart, Stjepan Jurekovic, Ana Romac, Susan Honeywell, Mike Stephens, and Marjan Bace. I also thank my project editor, Deirdre Blanchfield-Hiam; my copy editor, Christian Berk; my proofreader, Katie Tennant; and my technical proofreader, Ernest Gabriel Bossi Carranza.

My stellar tech editor, Jamie Riedesel, deserves a huge shout-out! Jamie is a staff engineer at Dropbox with over twenty years of experience in IT. She influenced and shaped this book significantly, providing guidance on how to explain things, feedback on technical aspects, and motivation to try even harder. Thank you. But I'd also like to thank a number of folks who provided feedback on various chapters, sharing valuable insights: Frederic Branczyk, Matthias Loibl, Kit Merker; and Manning reviewers Adrian Buturuga, Alessandro Campeis, Bhavin Thaker, Bobby Lin, Borko Djurkovic, Chris Haggstrom, Clifford Thurber, Doyle Turner, Ernesto Bossi, Fernando Bernardino, Filipe Teixeira, Ganesh Swaminathan, Ian Bartholomew, Ioannis Atsonios, Jakub